CHAPTER III.

ORGANS OF GENERATION.

The pelvis, or basin, situated in the adult about the middle of the body, is, as before stated, a large bony cavity, open above and below, and contains a portion of the intestines and the urinary and genital organs; serving as well for the strong points of articulations of the lower limbs, the attachment of their muscles, and the accomplishment of their movements. It is composed of four flat, broad, unequally thick bones, which are different in shape, size, and association, touching and articulated at some part of their surface, and closely united by extensions of muscular fibres or ligamentous fasciæ.

The pelvis supports the vertebral column behind, and is sustained in front by the ossa femorum, or thigh bone.

The sacrum and coccyx form the median line of the junction of the posterior pelvic bones, and the two anterior bones are united before and at the sides—called illio. (See Figs. 15 and 16.)

The chief office of the pelvis seems to be, in the female, the protection of the fœtus, and the parts inservient to reproduction.

The organs of reproduction, differing in the male and female, bear a singular resemblance in the pecu-